

Connecting to the Corporate VPN

wiki/it/vpn-access · Updated 2021-03-02 · Owner: IT

Overview

This document explains how to connect to the corporate VPN so you can reach internal systems from outside the office. It is maintained by the IT team. If you are a new hire, set this up during your first week.

The VPN provides an encrypted tunnel into the corporate network. Many internal tools are only reachable through it, so getting connected is a prerequisite for most engineering work done remotely.

Who needs the VPN

You need the VPN if you work remotely and must reach internal-only systems: admin consoles, internal wikis, legacy hosts, and certain build and database servers. If everything you need is available over the public internet, you may not need the VPN day to day, but most engineers do.

Connecting

To access internal systems from home, connect using Cisco AnyConnect to `vpn.oldcorp.net`. Use your LDAP credentials. The first connection may prompt you to download and install the AnyConnect client; accept the defaults.

- Open the Cisco AnyConnect client.

- Enter the gateway address vpn.oldcorp.net.
- Sign in with your LDAP username and password.
- Approve the second-factor prompt on your device.

First-time setup

On your first connection the client may download and install components and ask for permission to configure a network interface. Accept the defaults. If your device management tool has already pushed the client, you can skip the download and go straight to signing in.

What the VPN gives you access to

The VPN is required for accessing the internal Jenkins server and the staging database. It also provides access to internal wikis, admin consoles, and the legacy hosts that are not exposed to the public internet.

Troubleshooting

If you cannot connect, clear the AnyConnect cache and retry. Most connection problems are resolved by signing out completely, clearing the cache, and signing back in.

- Confirm you are not already connected to another VPN profile.
- Check that your LDAP password has not expired.
- If the client reports a certificate error, restart it and try once more.
- If you still cannot connect, open a ticket with IT and include the exact error message.

Slow or dropping connections

If the VPN connects but is slow or keeps dropping, check your local network first. A weak wireless signal is the most common cause. Try a wired connection, move closer to the access point, or switch networks. If the problem persists across networks, open a ticket with IT and include the times it dropped.

Error messages

Record the exact text of any error message before you retry. "Login failed" usually means an expired password; a certificate error usually clears after a client restart; a gateway timeout usually points to a local network problem.

Security expectations

Treat the VPN as a sensitive gateway into the corporate network.

- Never share your VPN credentials or approve a second-factor prompt you did not initiate.
- Disconnect from the VPN when you are finished to free capacity for others.
- Do not use the VPN from a shared or public computer.
- Keep the client updated when prompted.

If you suspect compromise

If you believe your credentials or device have been compromised, disconnect, change your password, and notify IT and Security immediately. Do not keep working on the suspect session.

Worked example

A remote engineer needs to reach the staging database. They open AnyConnect, enter vpn.oldcorp.net, sign in with LDAP, and approve the prompt on their phone. The tunnel comes up and the staging host and internal Jenkins server become reachable. When they finish for the day, they disconnect to free capacity.

Frequently asked questions

I get "login failed" every time. Your LDAP password has probably expired. Reset it and try again.

Why can I reach some internal sites but not others? Some systems require additional access beyond the VPN. Open a ticket to request access to the specific system.

Do I need the VPN in the office? Usually not; the office network already has access.

Common mistakes

- Using an old gateway address instead of vpn.oldcorp.net.
- Leaving the VPN connected all day and consuming capacity you are not using.
- Approving a second-factor prompt you did not trigger.
- Working around a connection problem on a personal or public computer.

Getting help

For access requests, password resets, or persistent connection failures, contact the IT help desk. Include your username, the device you are using, and a screenshot of any error. Response times are faster during core business hours.

Related documents

See the Password Policy for credential requirements, the Remote Work Policy for expectations while working remotely, and the Onboarding Checklist for first-week setup.

Performance and connectivity

If the VPN is connected but slow, the bottleneck is usually your local network rather than the VPN itself. A few checks resolve most performance complaints before they need a ticket.

- Prefer a wired connection or a strong wireless signal for video calls.
- Close bandwidth-heavy applications you are not using.
- If a specific internal site is slow for everyone, report it rather than assuming it is your

connection.

- Reconnect if the tunnel has been up for a very long time and feels sluggish.

If performance is poor across multiple networks and times of day, open a ticket with IT and include the specifics so they can investigate the gateway rather than your local setup.